

UNIVERSITY OF NOTRE DAME INFORMED CONSENT STATEMENT FOR RESEARCH

Enhancing Narrative Recall in Career Preparation: A Rui Robot Pilot for Behavioral Mock Interviews with Business Undergraduates
Ahmed Abbasi

ABOUT THIS RESEARCH

You are being asked to participate in a research study. Scientists do research to answer questions and learn new information. Some research might help change or improve the way we do things in the future. This consent form will give you information about the study to help you decide whether you want to participate. Please read this form and ask any questions you have before agreeing to be in the study.

TAKING PART IN THIS STUDY IS VOLUNTARY

You may choose not to take part in the study or may choose to leave the study at any time. Deciding not to participate, or deciding to leave the study later, will not result in any penalty or loss of benefits to which you are entitled and will not affect your relationship with The University of Notre Dame.

As an alternative to participating in the study, you may choose not to take part.

WHY IS THIS STUDY BEING DONE?

The purpose of this study is to investigate how an LLM-powered social robot supports behavioral interview preparation. The study aims to advance interactive AI technologies that optimize human-robot communication and deliver personalized support across professional and assistive care environments.

You were selected as a possible participant because you have work experience in Human Resources.

The study is being conducted by Ahmed Abbasi, Professor in the Department of IT, Analytics, and Operations at the University of Notre Dame.

HOW MANY PEOPLE WILL TAKE PART?

If you agree to participate, you will be one of 20 participants taking part in this study.

WHAT WILL HAPPEN DURING THE STUDY?

If you agree to be in the study, you will be asked to do the following things:

- You will complete a one-time online data-annotation task on Prolific, where you will review short, processed media clips and complete a standardized scoring sheet based on your professional HR experience.
- The task will be performed remotely on your own computer in a single session and is expected to take approximately 20 minutes (total participation is limited to this one session).
- The only study activities involve viewing the processed clips and providing ratings/comments; no in-person visits, follow-up sessions, or experimental interventions will occur for you as an annotator.
- Your participation consists solely of this professional evaluation task.

WHAT ARE THE RISKS OF TAKING PART IN THE STUDY?

While participating in the study, the potential risks of participating in this study are minimal and are not expected to be greater than those you would encounter in everyday life or routine computer work. The potential risks include:

- **Breach of Confidentiality:** As with any online research, there is a slight risk of a breach of confidentiality regarding your Prolific ID and the evaluation scores you provide. However, we use secure, encrypted University systems to store all data to minimize this risk, and we do not collect your name or direct contact information.

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- **Mild Fatigue:** You may experience mild fatigue or eye strain from viewing the media clips and completing the online scoring sheet. You are free to take short breaks away from the screen as needed.

If you feel uncomfortable at any point, you may stop the task and exit the study without penalty.

To minimize the risks described above, you may take breaks as needed, skip any item you do not wish to complete, and you may stop participation at any time by exiting the task without penalty. To minimize confidentiality risk, you will only be shown processed, de-identified media (with video blurred and audio distorted), and you will not be provided any identifying information about the individuals in the recordings. Your responses will be linked only to your Prolific participant ID (not your name), stored on secure, encrypted Notre Dame systems, and accessible only to authorized research personnel for research purposes. Because participation is minimal risk, no psychological, social, or medical services are anticipated or required as a result of participation; however, if you report discomfort or appear distressed, the researcher may terminate your participation and instruct you to stop the task.

WHAT ARE THE POTENTIAL BENEFITS OF TAKING PART IN THE STUDY?

We don't expect you to receive any benefit from taking part in this study, but we hope to learn things that will help scientists in the future.

HOW WILL MY INFORMATION BE PROTECTED?

Efforts will be made to keep your personal information confidential. We cannot guarantee absolute confidentiality. Your personal information may be disclosed if required by law. No information which could identify you will be shared in publications about this study and databases in which results may be stored.

Organizations that may inspect and/or copy your research records for quality assurance and data analysis include groups such as the study investigator and his/her research associates, the University of Notre Dame Institutional Review Board or its designees, and (as allowed by law) state or federal agencies, especially the Office for Human Research Protections (OHRP), who may need to access the research records.

WILL I BE PAID FOR PARTICIPATION?

You will receive **\$12** prorated in compensation through the Prolific platform for completing this one-time annotation task (estimated **20 minutes**). If you choose to stop before finishing, you will receive **partial payment on a prorated basis** for the portion completed **only if you submit the task with usable completed work**; if you exit without submitting, payment may not be issued. Compensation will be provided through Prolific after your submission is reviewed/approved in accordance with Prolific's standard payment procedures, and there are no additional costs to you for participating.

WHO SHOULD I CALL WITH QUESTIONS OR PROBLEMS?

For questions about the study, contact the researcher, Sofia Calderon at (574) 631-6183.

For questions about your rights as a research participant, to discuss problems, complaints, or concerns about a research study, please contact Notre Dame Research Compliance at 574-631-1461 or at compliance@nd.edu.

PARTICIPANT'S CONSENT

In consideration of all of the above, I give my consent to participate in this research study. I will be given a copy of this informed consent document to keep for my records. I agree to take part in this study.